BOOK · PORTFOLIO 2026

Paul Houdebine

End-to-end Product Designer

Product vision, user research, UX/UI, design systems and front-end, from framing to production.

paulhoudebine.com

Based between Bordeaux and Paris



BOOK 2026

Contents

Six chapters, from the most recent to the oldest: my current role at UpikaJob first, then the experiences that came before it.

Videos play with a click on their thumbnail. Projects, case studies and the full method at **paulhoudebine.com**.



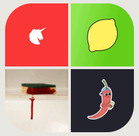
01 **About me** — Background, skills and method — 03

02 **UpikaJob** — An HRIS with AI-assisted reviews · since 2024 — 06

03 **Memento** — First designer at a startup · 2021 - 2022 — 16

04 **Yves Delorme** — L'Odyssée, HETIC professional project · 2019 - 2020 — 20

05 **SÆGUS** — Assignments for Orange, the Sanofi Espoir Foundation and Capgemini · 2019 and 2020 — 23



06 **Other projects** — Fidesio, Baio, Le Grand Ménage, archive and exercises — 27



About me

As a Product Designer, I design products end to end: from product vision and user research through to the front-end.



Paul Houdebine

PRODUCT DESIGNER

B2B SaaS · HR Tech · AI · Design systems · Front-end

Based between Bordeaux and Paris

SKILLS

Product discovery, user interviews and testing, UX/UI, prototyping, design systems and tokens, front-end integration, sprint work with developers, motion design.

TOOLS

Figma · Miro · Adobe suite · HTML · CSS · JS · Tailwind · Symfony · Cursor · Claude · Blender

ABOUT

I design products end to end

My name is Paul Houdebine and I am a Product Designer. I design products end to end: from product vision and user research through to the front-end, shipped in pair with developers.

At UpikaJob, I have been the sole designer since 2024. I frame the UX decisions, gather client feedback myself, keep the design system alive and take charge of the front-end. I designed and built the screens for its AI features: the chatbot and AI-generated summaries. I also carry the brand: website, print, motion, video.

WHAT I DO

Product vision and framing, user research and testing, UX/UI design, AI features, design systems, specs and front-end, plus the brand: website, print, motion design and video.

BACKGROUND

2024 - TODAY
UpikaJob Product Designer, sole designer
An HRIS with AI-assisted reviews

2021 - 2022
Memento First designer, apprenticeship
A SaaS redistributing event photos

2020
SÆGUS Junior design consultant, second internship
Assignment for Orange, internal communication

2019 - 2020
Yves Delorme HETIC professional project
Digital ecosystem redesign, 5 months

2019
SÆGUS Junior consultant, first internship
Sanofi Espoir Foundation, Capgemini

2018
Fidesio UX/UI internship at a web agency
Interfaces, internal tool, newsletters

2016 - 2021
HETIC Grande École programme, master's degree
Web design, web development, digital marketing; Product Design specialisation

MY METHOD

Design does not start in Figma

It starts with understanding the problem, looking for leads beyond existing solutions, then making ideas concrete as early as possible: a mock-up, a prototype or a first version that works.

01

UNDERSTAND

Understand before designing

Finding the right problem to solve matters more than the first solution that comes to mind. At UpikaJob, I gather client feedback myself: that is often where the real priorities lie.

Interviews · Feedback analysis · Benchmark

02

EXPLORE

Feeding the thinking

Looking elsewhere, so as not to mechanically reproduce what already exists. Opening several directions before choosing one, spotting what can surprise without confusing.

Design watch · References · Design systems

03

DESIGN

Making ideas tangible

The sooner an idea takes shape, the sooner we see whether it holds. A wireframe validates a structure, a prototype validates an interaction.

Wireframes · Prototypes · Figma

04

EXPERIMENT

Experimenting and building

Between the mock-up and the product, the line has become more fluid. I move from design to implementation: at UpikaJob, I take charge of the front-end.

Front-end · 3D · Claude Code

05

VALIDATE

Validating, iterating, improving

Reconciling usability, visual consistency, technical feasibility and business goals. I follow a feature all the way to production, then watch how it lives.

User testing · Iterations · Follow-up

These five moments are not a straight line: they overlap and repeat, and I scale them to the project, the time available and what is at stake.

WITH AI

AI as a design partner

Not to go faster at all costs: to explore more possibilities, and to bring to life ideas I would not have had time to build. GPT to structure my thinking, Claude and Claude Code to go from an idea to a first version that works.

What remains mine: framing the problem, choosing the creative direction, assessing the results and making the calls. AI does not replace my reasoning as a Product Designer, it equips it.

02

UpikaJob

An HRIS with AI-assisted reviews, for HR teams and managers.

Full-time · since January 2024 · sole designer

UPIKAJOB · OVERVIEW

Sole designer of an HRIS where AI assists reviews

Full-time · since January 2024 · Product Designer

A platform born to support young talent, now an HRIS where AI assists reviews. I am its sole designer, from product vision through to the front-end.

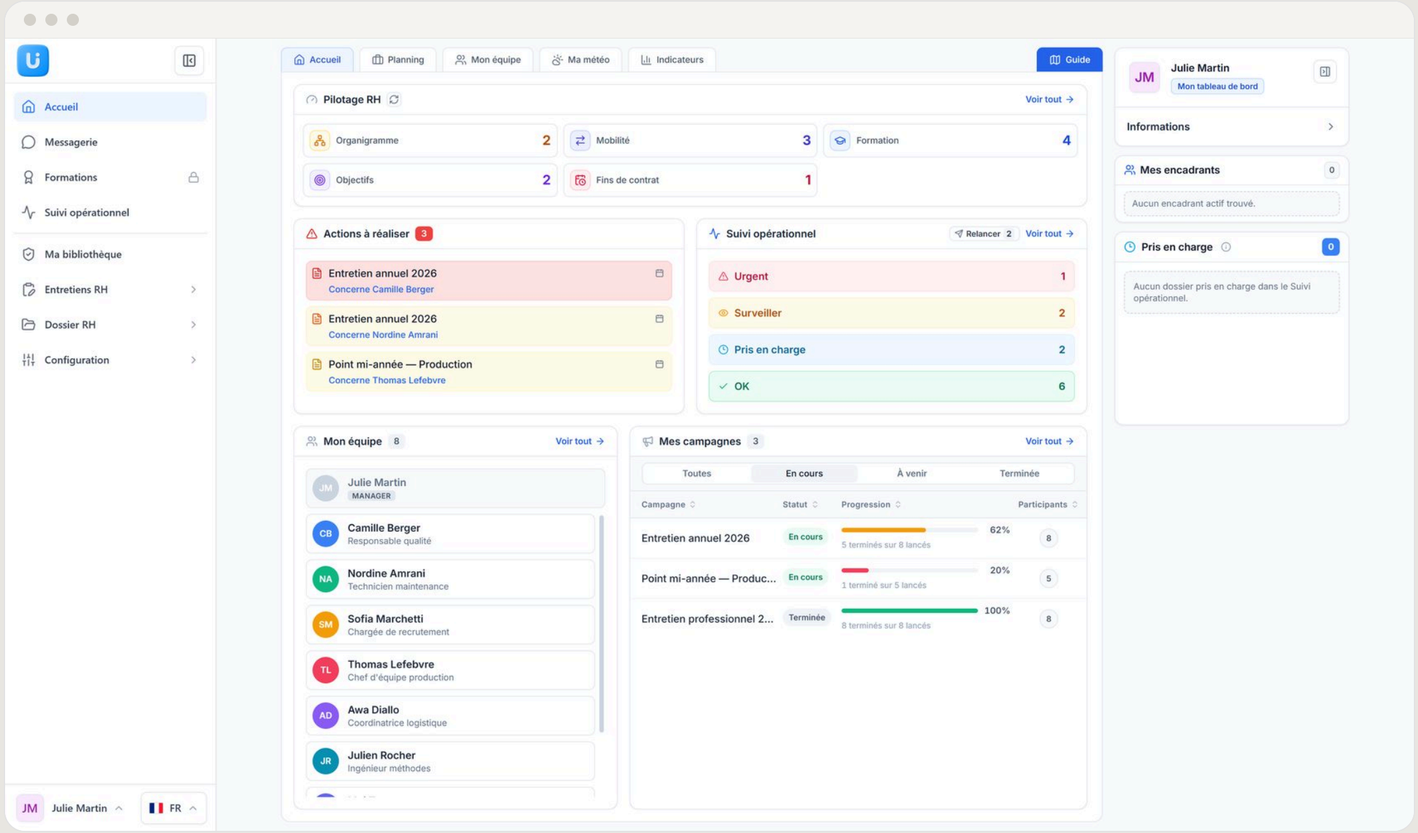
200,000
AI-assisted reviews

50,000
employees, in large groups

> 80%
usage rate

2025
Sopra Steria AI & HR Innovation Award, with SPIE

An HRIS deployed at SPIE, Fayat, RATP and Altrad. AI-assisted reviews sit at the heart of the product: I designed their flows and built their screens.



1 The dashboard, demo data

MY ROLE

- Product vision and UX decisions, client feedback gathered first-hand
- Flows and screens for the AI features: chatbot, summaries
- Design system and front-end, paired with the developer
- Brand identity, marketing site designed then built on my own

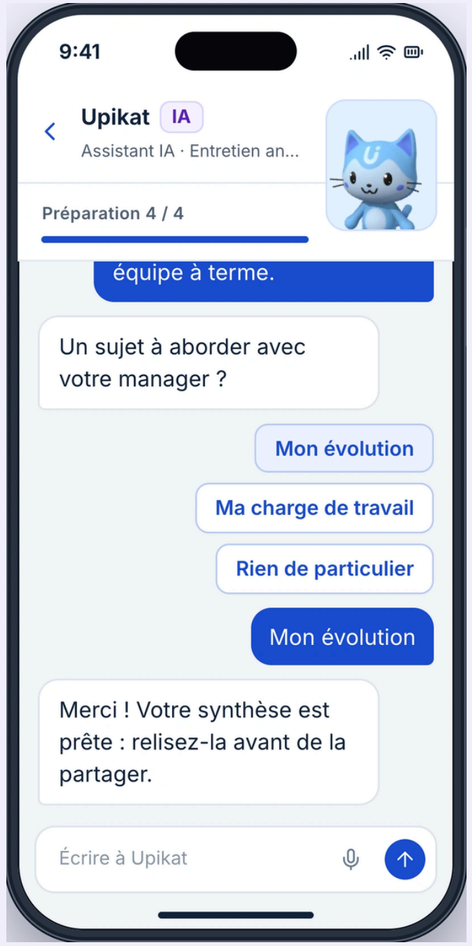
AI AT THE HEART OF THE PRODUCT

A review prepared with Upikat

Upikat asks the questions of the review template, one at a time. Employees answer however they like, with a tap, in writing or out loud; the AI turns it into a clear summary, which they read over before sharing it with their manager.

DESIGN CHOICES

- One question at a time, asked by an assistant without a human face
- Three ways to answer, so everyone can express themselves comfortably
- The summary stays with the employee: they read it over before any sharing



1 The preparation, one question at a time



2 The summary drafted by the AI, read over by the employee

A fictional example, taken from the demo I designed for the marketing site.

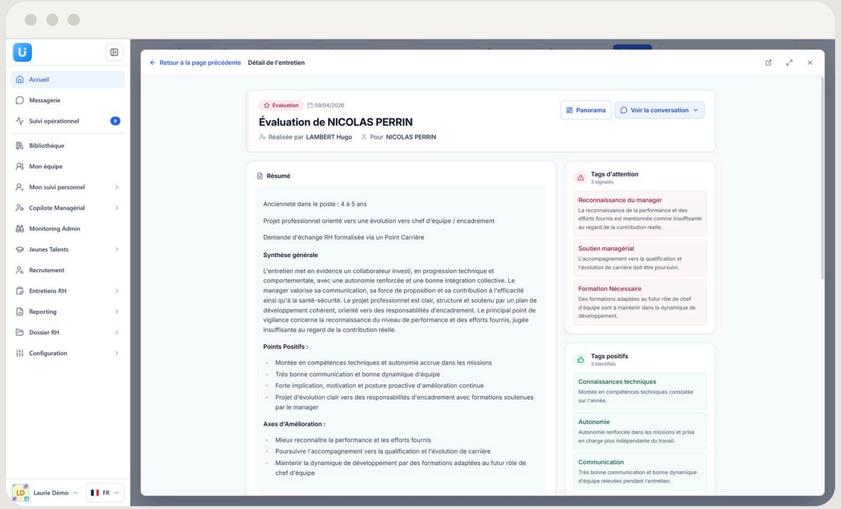
THE PRODUCT TODAY

An HRIS that equips HR teams and managers day to day

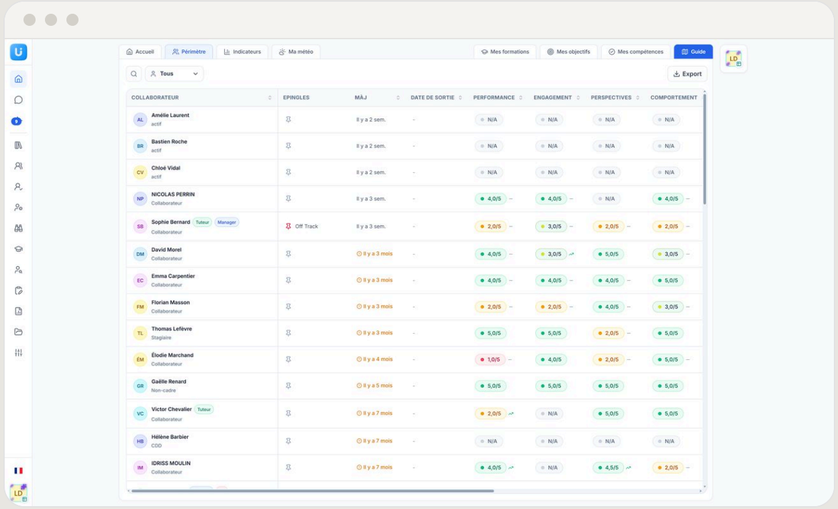
People steering, review campaigns, AI-generated summaries, tracking indicators: designed screen by screen, then shipped in pair with the developer.

EACH BUILDING BLOCK HAS ITS OWN FRAMING

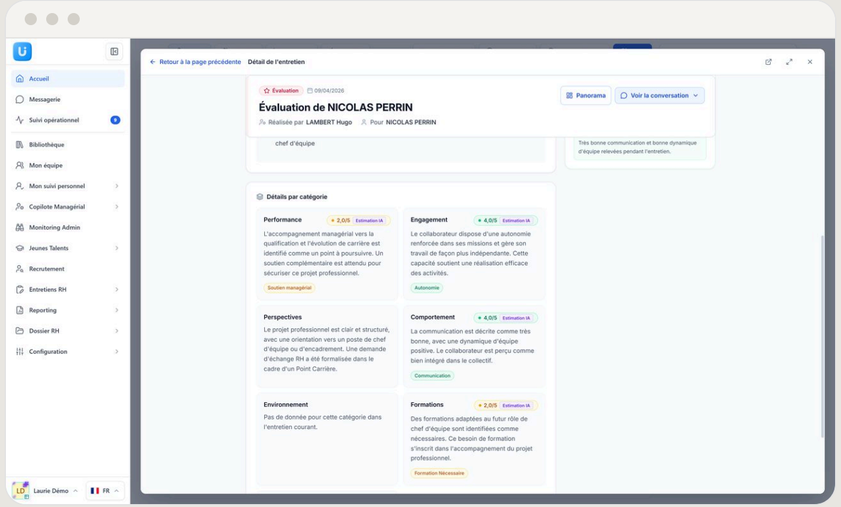
Annual reviews · AI summaries · Chatbot · Skills · Indicators · Employee profiles



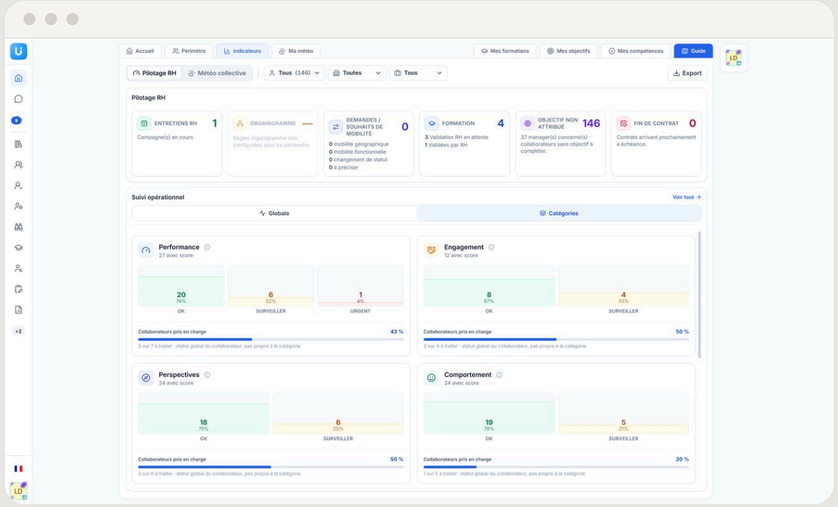
1 A review summary, generated by AI



2 A manager's scope



3 AI-estimated scores, category by category

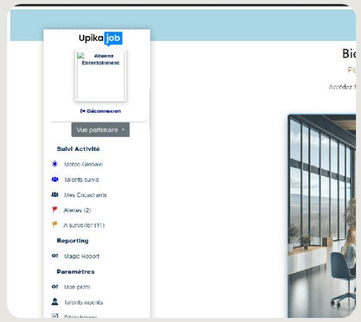


4 HR steering indicators

The product did not always look like this

From a tool for training organisations to an HRIS: I lived this transformation from the inside, from the first redesigns to the product as it stands today.

AT FIRST



A tool for training organisations

Tracking apprentices, interns and junior employees, day to day.

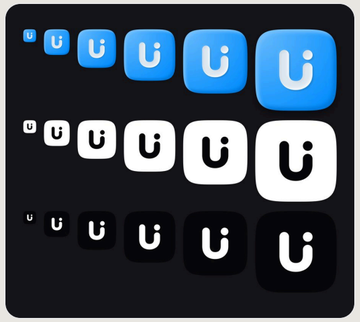
UI/UX Designer

I took over the existing journeys, made the screens more reliable and brought components into line.

FIRST TURN

The expertise built around young talent turns out to matter far beyond training organisations.

THEN



The scope widens

HR teams and managers become users in their own right.

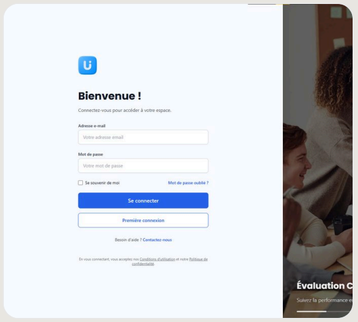
Designer of the redesigns

Successive redesigns, visual identity and logotype, first foundations of a design system with the developer.

CHANGE OF COURSE

UpikaJob becomes an HRIS, a complete HR platform, without giving up what it does best.

NEXT



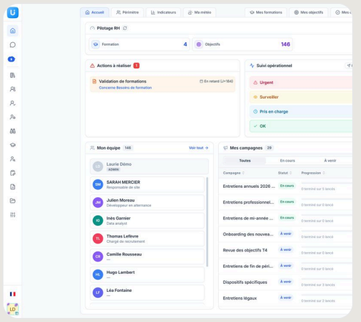
An HR platform

Talent management, team tracking, tools for managers.

Product Designer

I frame the product vision and UX decisions, then design the interface, screen after screen.

IN DEPTH



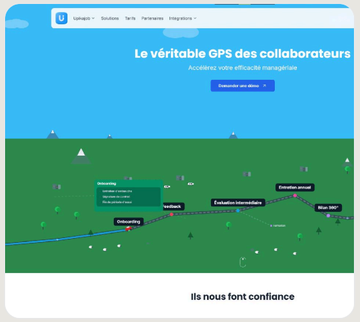
Features in their own right

Annual reviews, AI summaries, chatbot, skills, indicators, profiles.

Designing end to end

User interviews and tests, specs, sprints: from framing to release.

TODAY



An HRIS in its own right

It speaks to HR teams and managers right down to its public site: offering, pricing, documentation.

Design & implementation

Front-end paired with the developer; marketing site designed then built on my own.

THE DESIGN SYSTEM

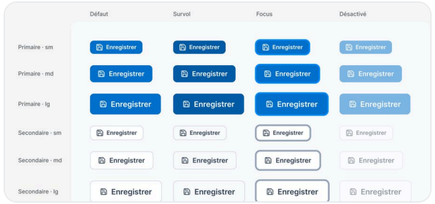
A shared language, built from the code

I rebuilt the app's entire design system in Figma, starting from the code: a component only enters the file once it exists in the app, and any gap gets fixed. Every component comes with its variants and states, is interactive, and carries the call the developer copies.



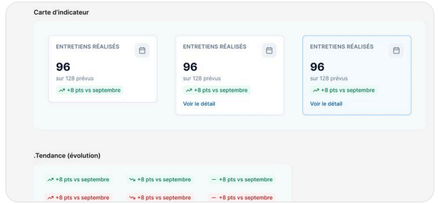
1 The file's cover: the app's foundations, atoms, molecules and organisms

FOUNDATIONS	The tokens: colors, typography, radii and spacing, elevation, icons.
ATOMS	Button, badges, checkboxes and radios, loading, avatars.
MOLECULES	Fields, dropdowns, search, tabs, tooltip, KPI card, toast.
ORGANISMS	Modal and action confirmation, data table.



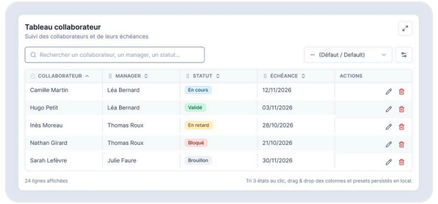
4,600

hand-copied buttons, replaced by a single component



55

copied KPI cards, migrating to the KPI card



213

existing tables, migrating to the data table

ONE DECISION, AND WHY

Fields you can tell apart from the page

At 1.48:1 on white, field borders were barely visible. At 4.8:1, they exceed the 3:1 that accessibility guidelines require for interface components (WCAG 1.4.11). The contrast of 43 color pairs was checked the same way.

BEFORE

Employee name

#cbd5e1 · **1.48:1**

AFTER

Employee name

#64748b · **4.8:1**



1 Fields in every state: empty, filled, focus, error, disabled

IN THE CODE

Moving off Bootstrap

Bootstrap first gave the application a default art direction. Once I had designed the whole interface, it was becoming a burden: three versions side by side, less consistent screens, slower development. Above all, it clashed with Tailwind: same class names, different values.

I decided to remove it in favor of Tailwind, and I'm running this project with AI agents: I set the scope and check the rendering. Removal happens one page template at a time, comparing styles before and after, and an automated check blocks Bootstrap from creeping back.

THE CLASH, IN PRACTICE

On a page that loaded Bootstrap, `p-4` meant 1.5rem instead of 1rem, and its `!important` rules overrode everything else. Its `.tooltip` class even made help icons invisible.

119
templates nothing called anymore, deleted

13,842
lines of code removed with them

≈ 160
pages on the Tailwind template, which no longer loads Bootstrap

Work in progress, figures as of November 5, 2026.

THE MASCOT

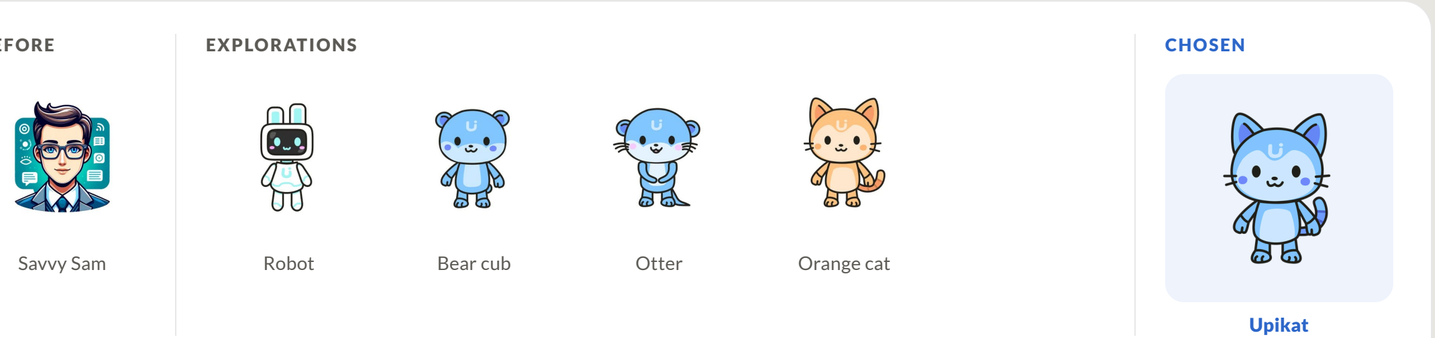
Upikat, from 2D to 3D

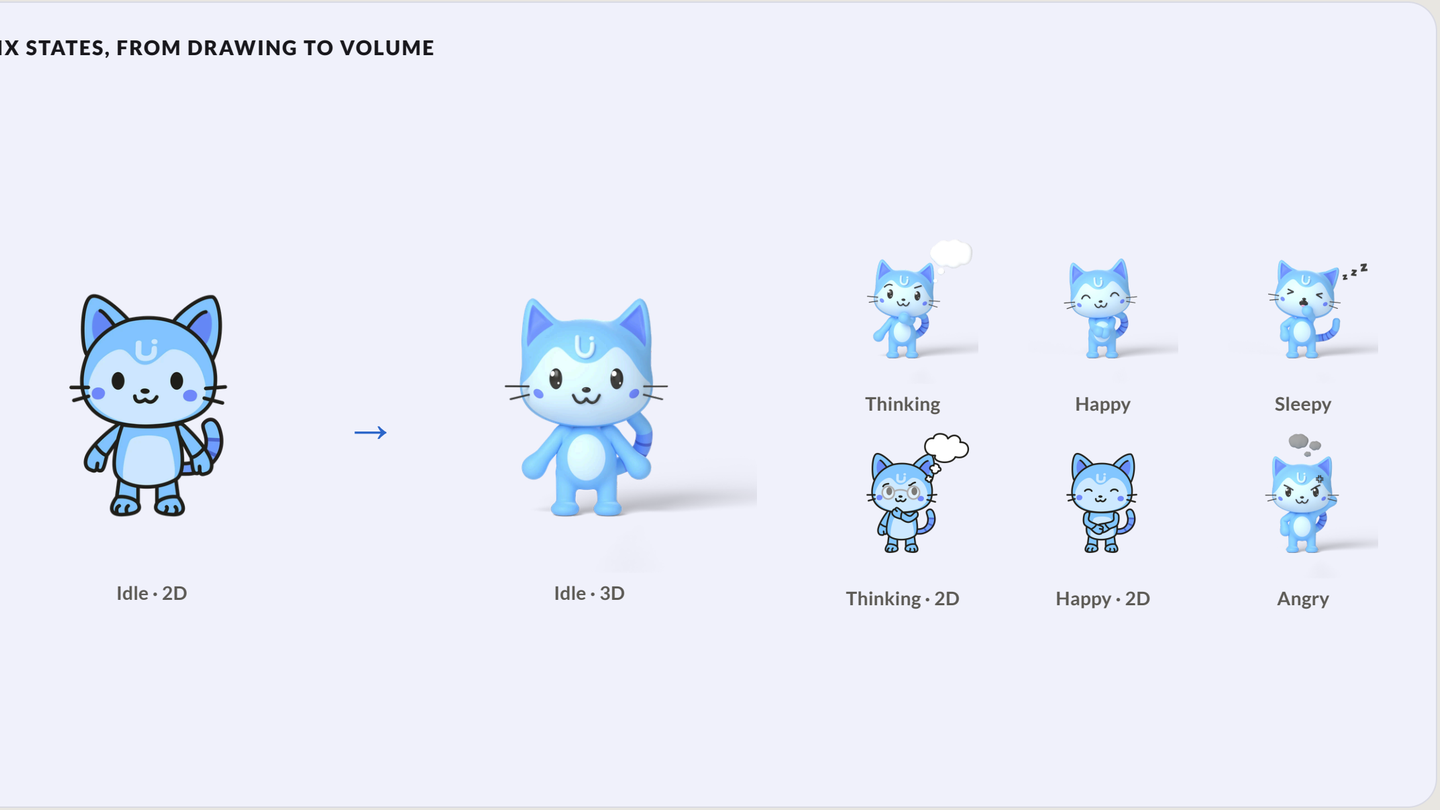
The assistant first had a human face. One remark kept coming back: it feels strange to talk to an almost human face when you know you are addressing an AI. Yet it is employees who feed the platform, and they were not completing enough reviews. The assistant had to be more approachable, something people want to engage with.

I championed this mascot project and explored several characters. The cat won everyone over: cute, soothing, it breaks with the robotic feel and makes the tool more human, which matters in HR. I came up with the name Upikat, chosen over Upi and UpikAI.

Flat design came naturally: I have drawn in a comic-book style for a long time and animated many flat characters in motion design. A simple line, designed from the start to be animated and turned into variations.

Shown to clients, including HR directors at SPIE, it was met with enthusiasm. I am now taking it to 3D in Blender, with AI: a work in progress.





RIGHT NOW

A ready-to-use offering

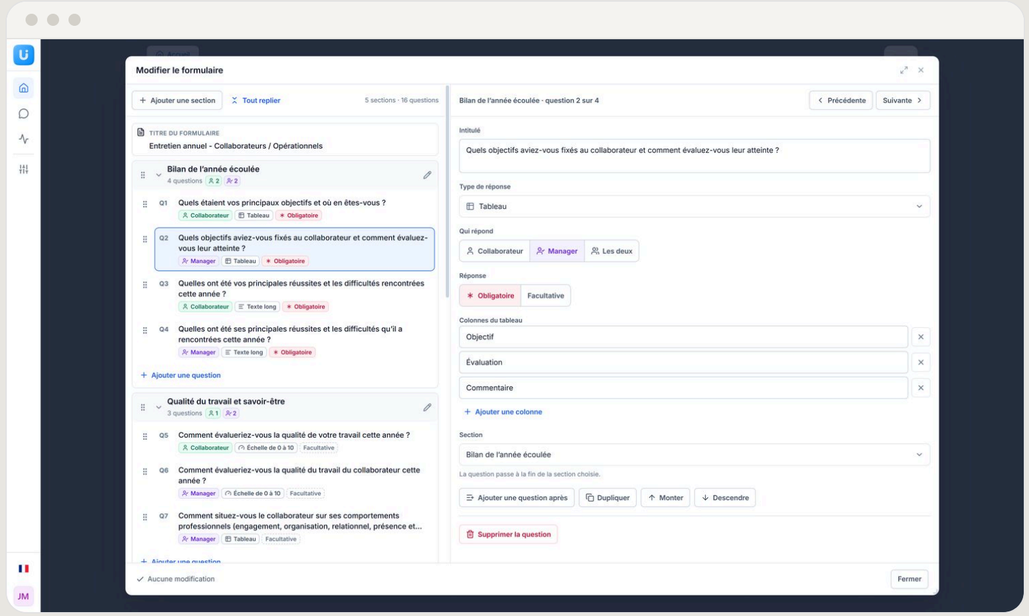
An online offering a company can get started with on its own: a six-step setup assistant, ready-to-use review templates and a card-based form editor.

DESIGNING THE ONBOARDING

I am putting the off-the-shelf offering in place: the setup guided by Upikat, the app's assistant, the review templates and the form editor.



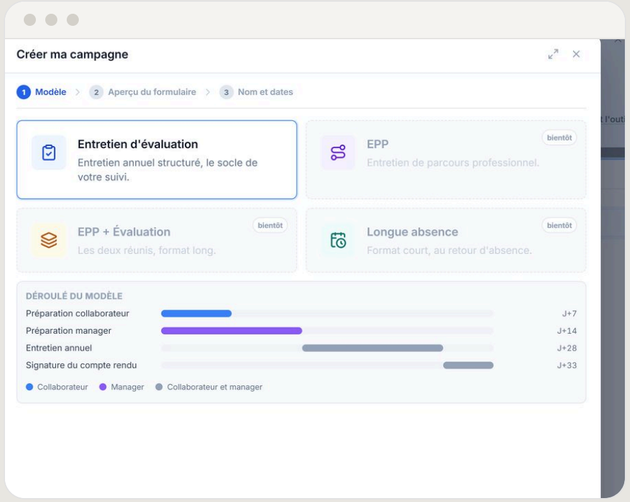
Upikat, the app's assistant, guides every step of the setup.



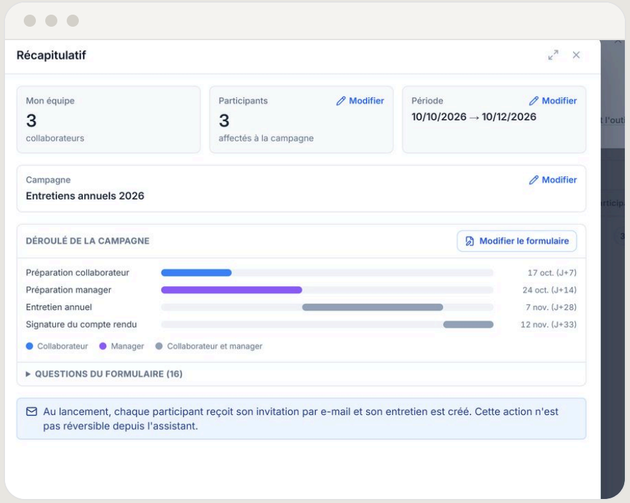
1 The card-based form editor



2 Upikat welcomes and guides the setup



3 Pick a template and see how it unfolds



4 The summary before launch

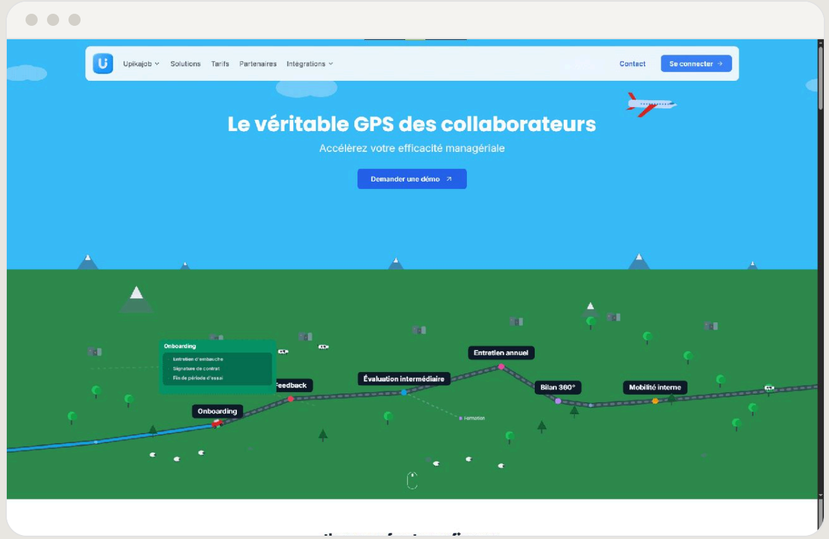
MARKETING SITE AND BRAND

Designed, then built on my own

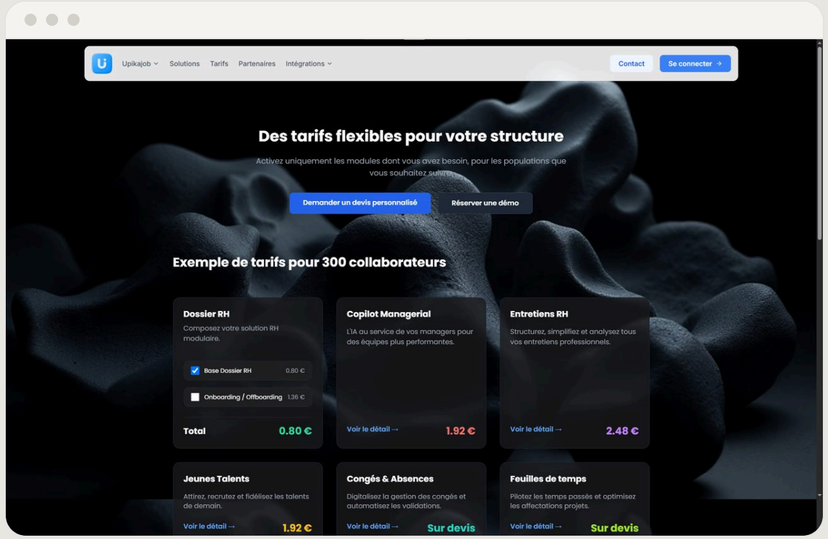
The platform speaks to HR teams and managers right down to its public site: offering, pricing, documentation. I designed then built the site on my own, with AI-assisted coding tools.

I also produce the brand's content: video, motion design, print, social media.

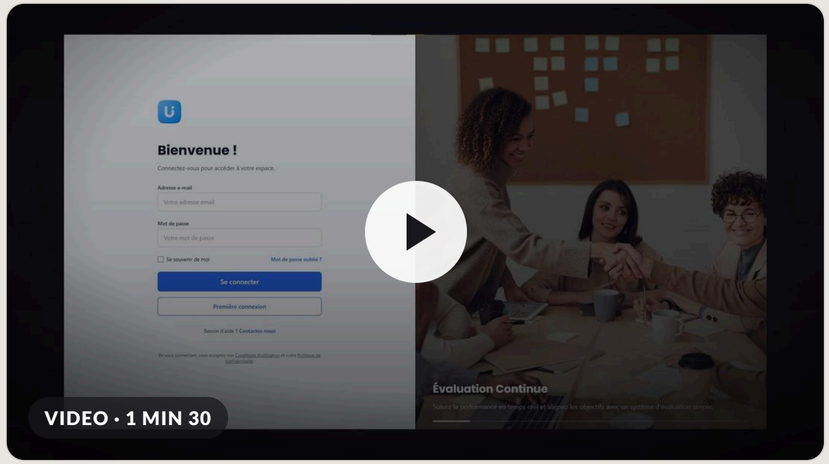
upikajob.com ↗



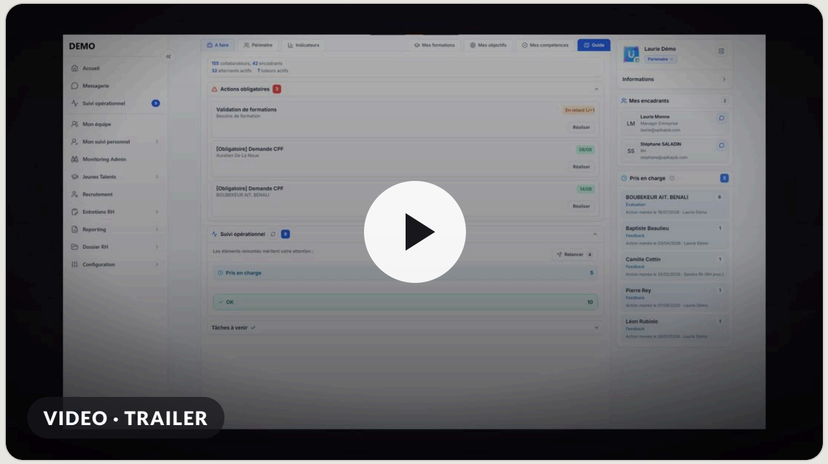
1 Site home page



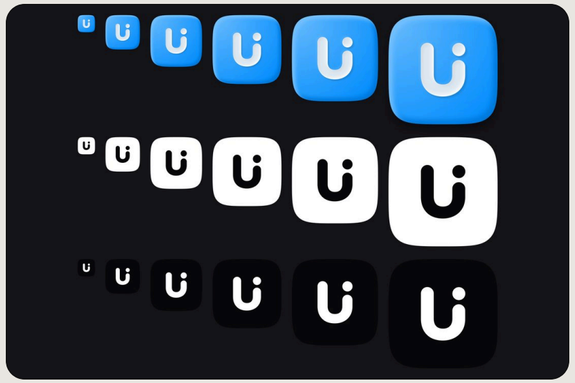
2 Pricing



3 The platform in ninety seconds



4 Platform presentation trailer



5 Logotype variations



MEMENTO

Memento

First designer at a startup: product, design system and content.

Apprenticeship · January 2021 - January 2022

MEMENTO · OVERVIEW

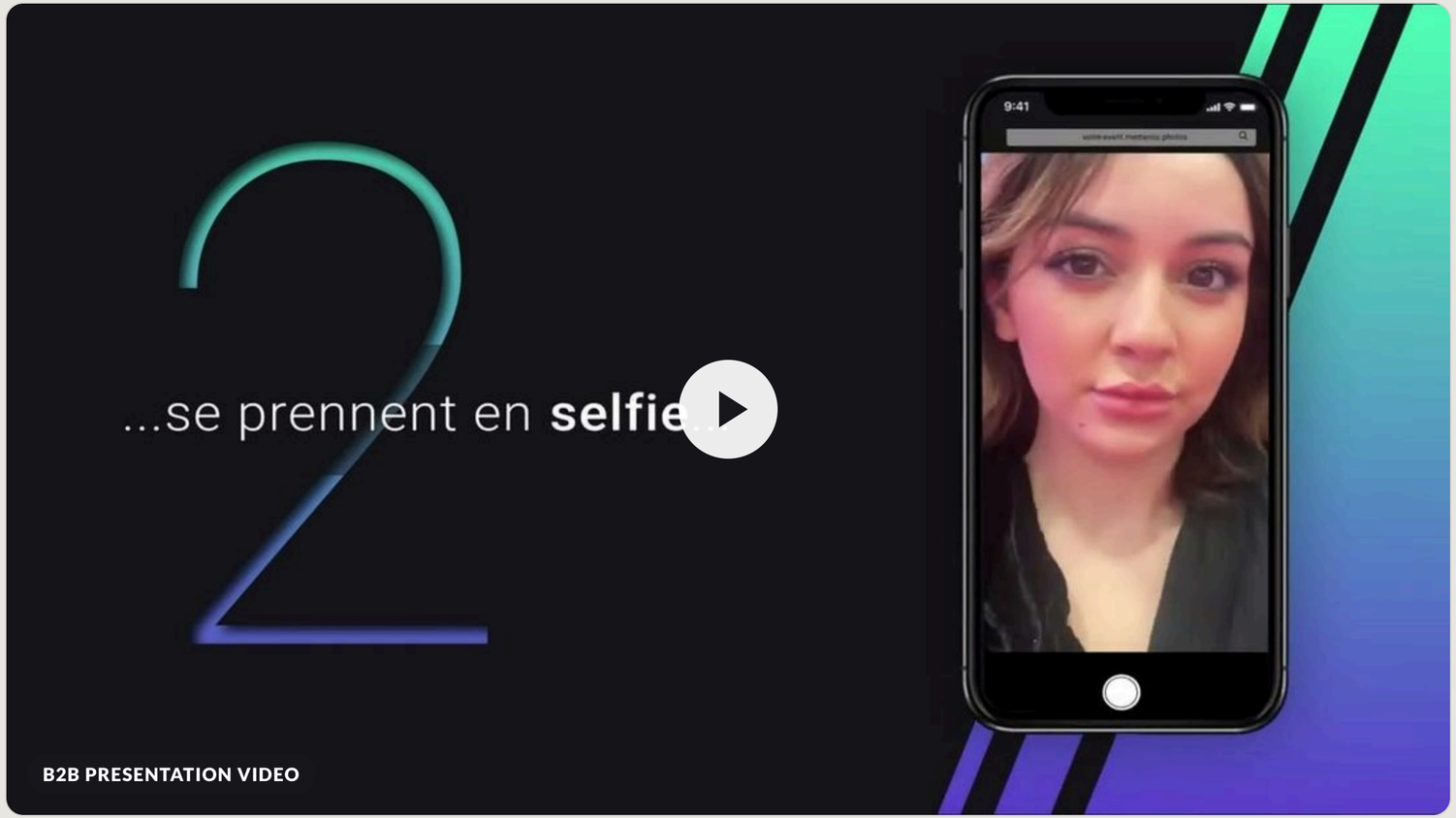
The startup's first designer

Apprenticeship · January 2021 - January 2022

Memento is a SaaS that hands every guest the photos taken of them at an event, using the cloud and facial recognition.

Memento had no designer yet. To grow, the team needed to improve its app and produce a lot of content at the same time: social media visuals, videos explaining the service, event materials.

I designed the app's new mockups and prototypes in Figma, and built then maintained an atomic design system so it could grow without losing consistency.



1 The presentation video, designed and animated in After Effects

Mockups and prototypes | Atomic design system | Motion design | Print

×3 The presentation video became the founders' go-to support to showcase the solution, and its release went hand in hand with **the client count tripling over three months**.

THE APP

Setting up a photo space in a few screens

The organizer opens their event's space, answers two questions that set what guests can see, then dresses it in their own colors.

1 Create the space

The event's name, date and type, then the organizer's email address and first name.

2 A tailored journey

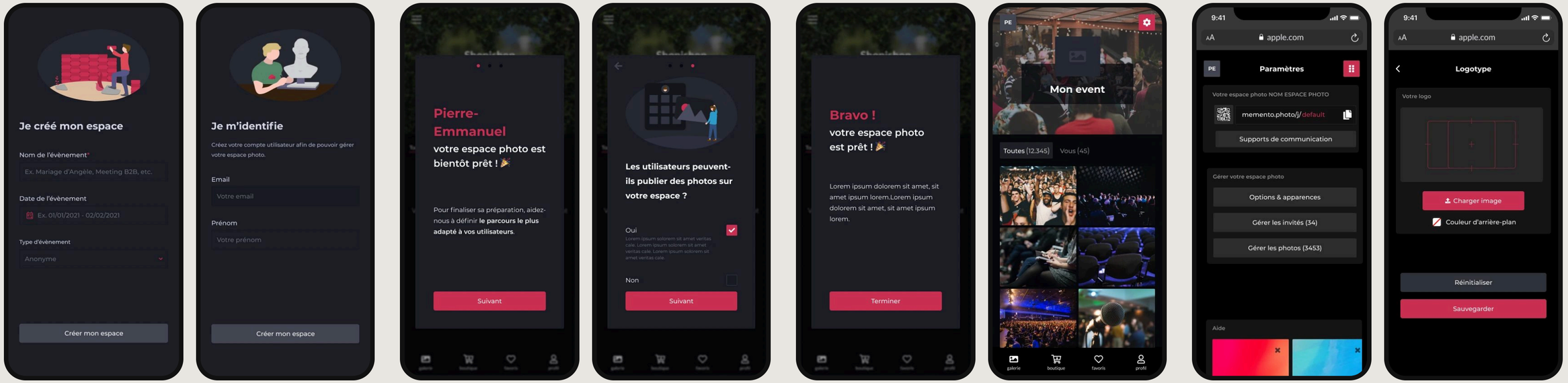
Two questions: which photos guests can access, and whether they can post some.

3 The space is ready

All the event's photos, and a “You” tab to find the ones you appear in.

4 In the organizer's colors

They manage guests and photos, and dress the space: logo, main color.

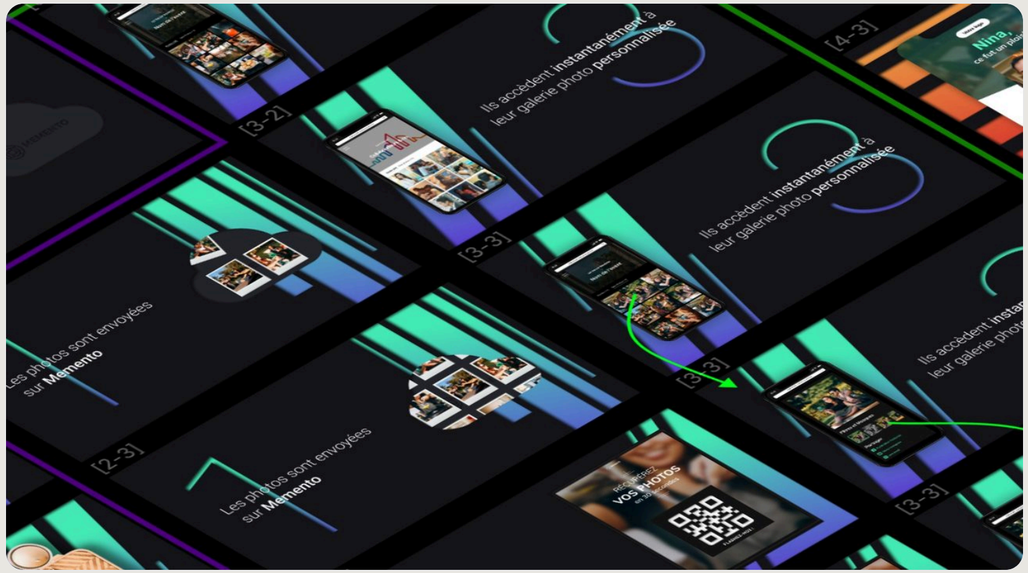


BRAND AND CONTENT

Videos, print and materials to grow

Alongside the app, I produced motion design videos in After Effects and print materials, roll-up banners, posters, flyers, in InDesign.

My work modernised Memento's identity, from social media to the materials set up at events.



1 Presentation storyboards



3 Commercial poster



4 QR code support



6 Event photography coverage



2 Offer summary and FAQ



5 Storyboard of a personalized thank-you video, after a trade show

04



Yves Delorme

L'Odyssée: a full redesign of Maison Yves Delorme's digital ecosystem.

HETIC professional project · 2019 - 2020

YVES DELORME · L'ODYSSÉE

Harmonizing the customer experience, from boutique to digital

HETIC · Client: Maison Yves Delorme · 2019 - 2020

L'Odyssée is a project to fully redesign the digital ecosystem of Maison Yves Delorme. It aims to harmonize the customer experience across the boutique, advisory services and digital tools.

I took part in all four of its strands: in-store research, mockups, the design system and the motion design presentation.

Our persona, Catherine, has been a sales associate for twenty years: the configurator was designed for her. During lockdown, testing was done over video calls.



1 In-store working session with the sales team

5 months
from January to May 2020

3 + 3
designers and developers

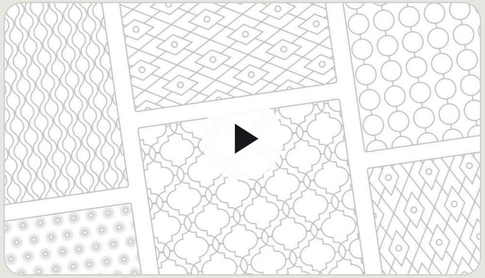
4
strands, from research to motion



2 Customer expectations and needs



3 Goals and communication strategy

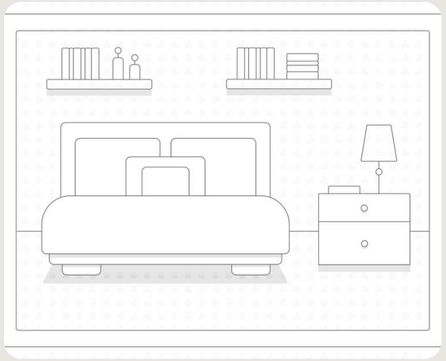


4 The product configurator on video

THE CONFIGURATOR

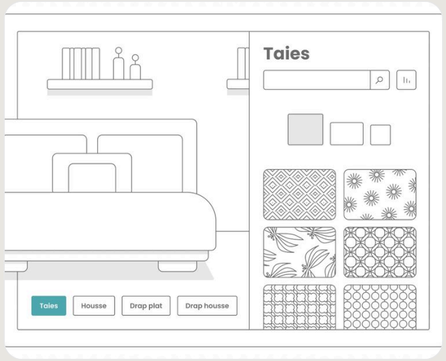
Building a bedding set with the customer, live

In store, it was hard to show a bedding set made of pieces from different collections. Designed for sales associates, the configurator displays a bedding set and swaps each of its pieces to build the one that best suits the customer.



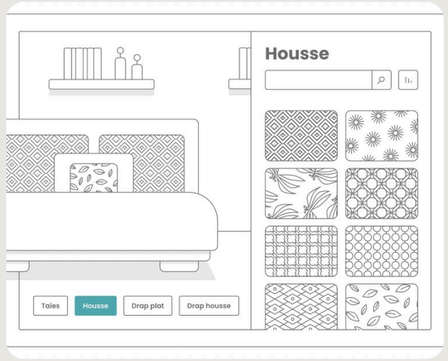
The set at the center

Every change shows up instantly on the bed, so the customer can picture it.



Each piece on its own

Pillowcases, duvet cover, flat sheet, fitted sheet: each piece changes on its own.



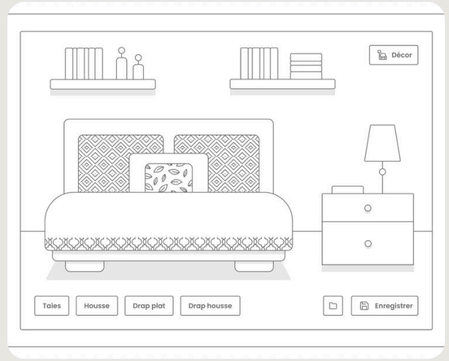
Filtering like in store

Color, material, style, pattern and thread count, a mark of quality.



Changing the room

Walls, floor and headboard change color and texture.



Save, share, buy

The set is saved, shared by email and bought on the website.

THE GUIDELINES

A design system to hand over to developers

At the developers' request, the whole Figma file was reworked and organized with atomic design: the integration built upon it.

PRIMARY

SECONDARY

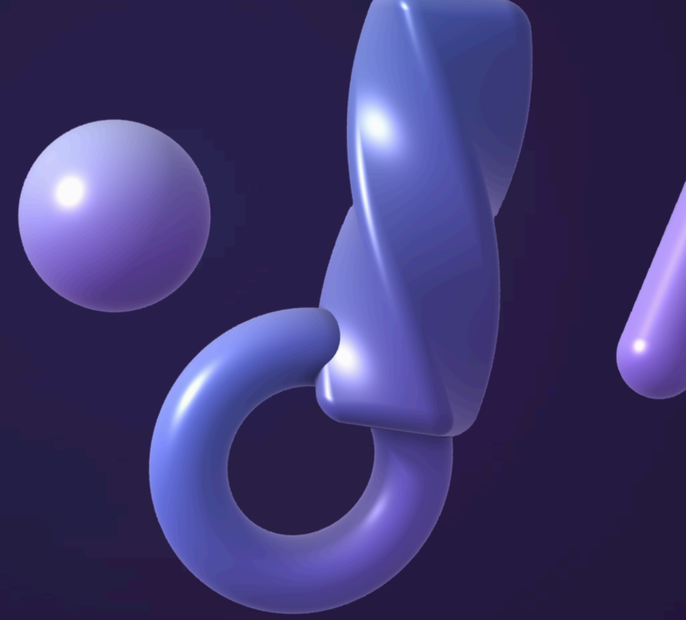
Décoration intérieure

Poppins Bold · headings

Ajouter au panier

Roboto · text and buttons

05



SÆGUS

Two internships as a junior design consultant at a consulting firm, for Orange, the Sanofi Espoir Foundation and Capgemini.

Internships · 2019 and 2020

ORANGE · JIVE

A design thinking add-on for Orange's intranet

Internship at SÆGUS · Client: Orange · 2020

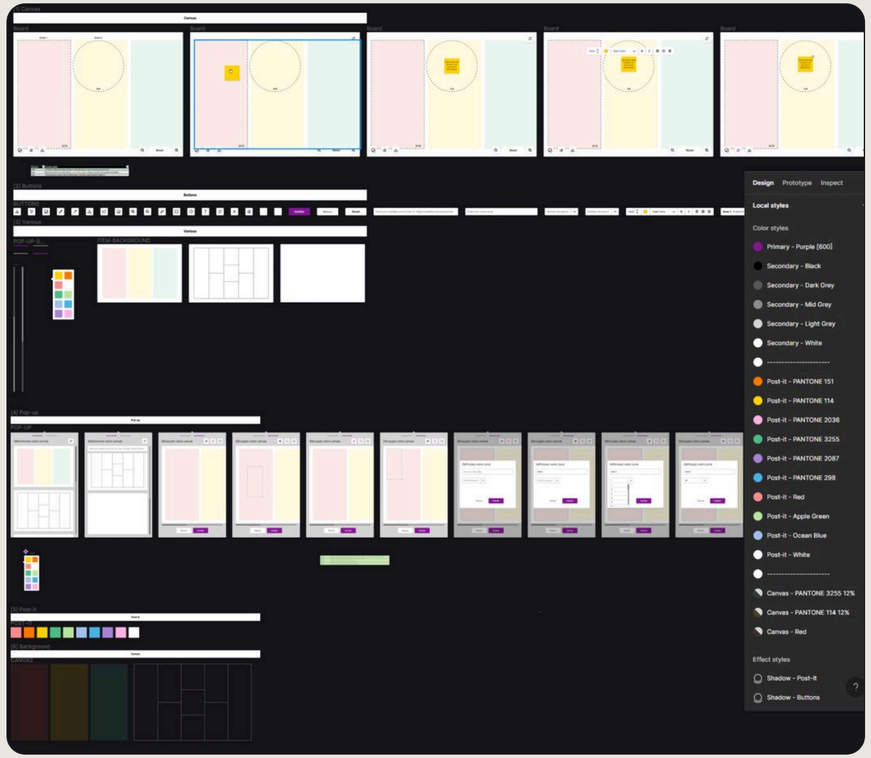
During my second internship at SÆGUS, I joined an Orange team as a junior design consultant. The goal: improve how Jive, the intranet employees use every day, was being used.

Orange needed to run Kanban-style ideation workshops directly in Jive, without multiplying external tools.

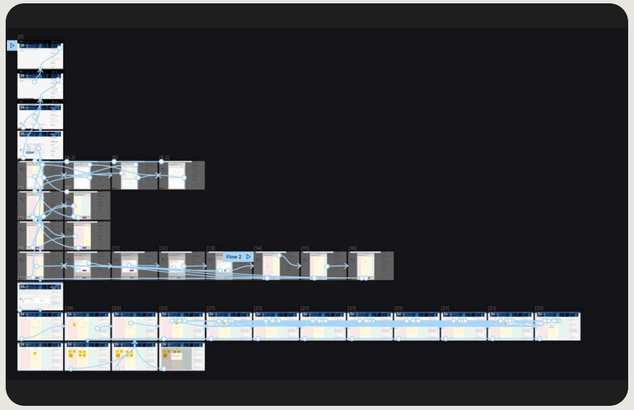
I led the design of an add-on following a design thinking approach: a workshop (Miro, Figma) to gather needs, then a tool made of reusable modules, designed together with a developer, from mockup through to integration.

OUTCOME

By the end of the mission, the Orange team had a ready-to-use tool to organise its work in Kanban within Jive itself.



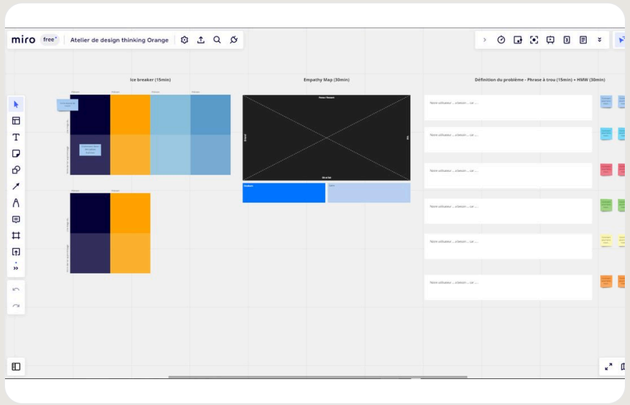
1 Design system organization



2 Prototype organization



4 Agile training feedback video, made for Orange during my first internship (2019)



3 Miro board organization

SANOFI ESPOIR FOUNDATION

Maternal and neonatal health in Senegal: strengthening local impact

Internship at SÆGUS · Client: Sanofi Espoir Foundation · 2019

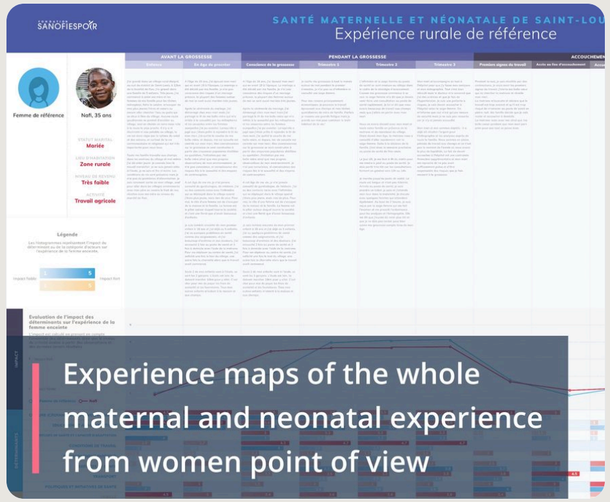
The goal was to better understand local care pathways to strengthen the foundation's impact. Teams had to reconcile field constraints, healthcare professionals' expectations and patients' needs.

The approach combined field immersion, interviews, workshops and visual synthesis. **I produced the workshop wrap-up content and contributed to the experience map of the women's journey.**

Journey maps, storyboards and experience maps helped the team guide its decisions in the field.



1 The wrap-up film



2 The experience map of the patients' journey



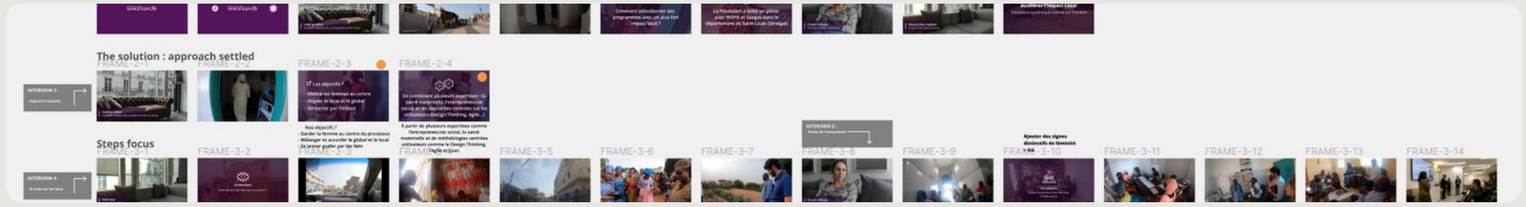
3 A field step with stakeholders



4 Ideation with the foundation's teams



5 Project presentation video



6 Film storyboard

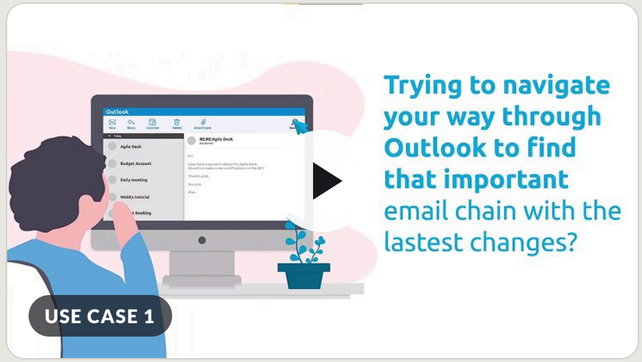
CAPGEMINI

Illustrating use cases to reach a broad audience

Internship at SÆGUS · Client: Capgemini · 2019

Animated videos featuring characters and sets, made in After Effects with the Duik plugin, to illustrate Microsoft 365 use cases. Four use cases, many scenes, a tight deadline for a long-standing client.

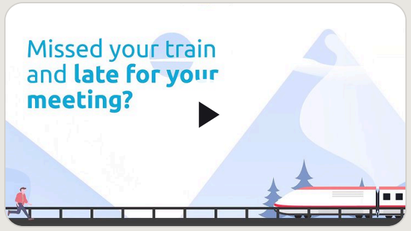
I ran production more and more autonomously. The project was delivered on time and helped the SÆGUS design team keep the client's trust.



1 Collaborating with Teams and SharePoint



2 Boosting productivity with OneDrive



3 Working from anywhere with Office Online

SÆGUS · INTERNAL PROJECT

2021 greeting card

Second internship · 2020



4 The digital greeting card

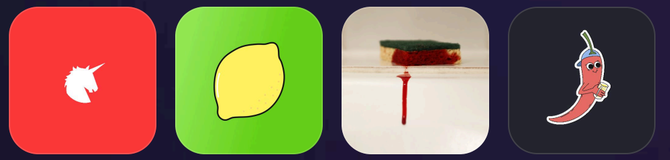
A landing page in desktop and mobile versions, adapted for emailing, print and LinkedIn: a strong visual direction around purple, key figures and testimonials, with a modular architecture designed for web and email.



5 Screens in Figma



6 Storyboard of a workshop feedback (REX) video I created



Other projects

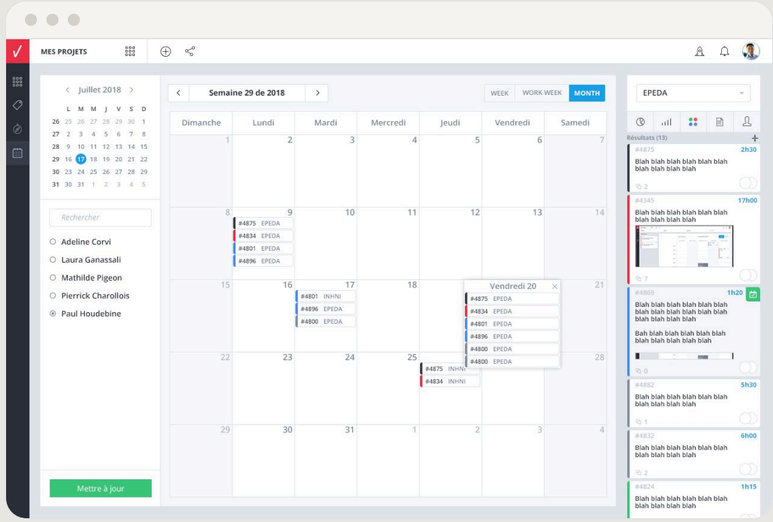
An internship at a web agency, an app concept, a short film, illustrations and design exercises.

FIDESIO · WEB AGENCY

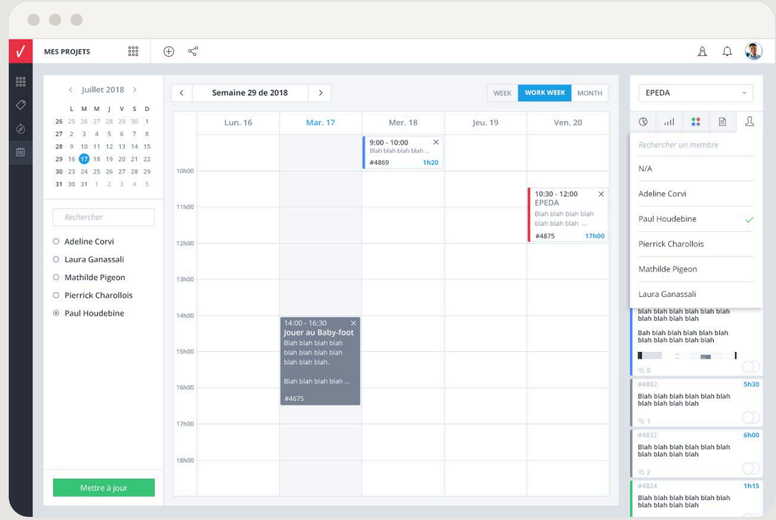
UX/UI and branding work at a web agency

UX/UI internship · July - September 2018

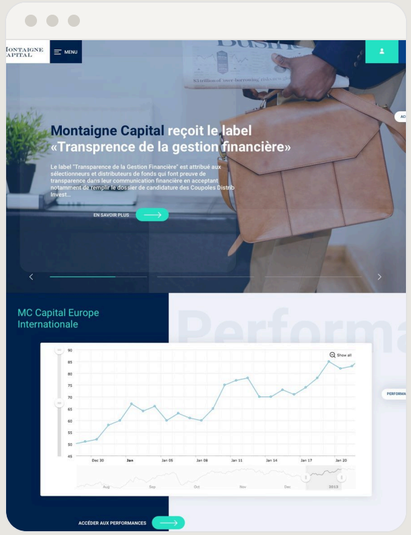
Three months at Fidesio, a Paris web agency, on interface and branding assignments for several clients and on the agency's internal tools. Interfaces designed following an atomic design convention, and “How Might We” UX workshops with user interviews and tests.



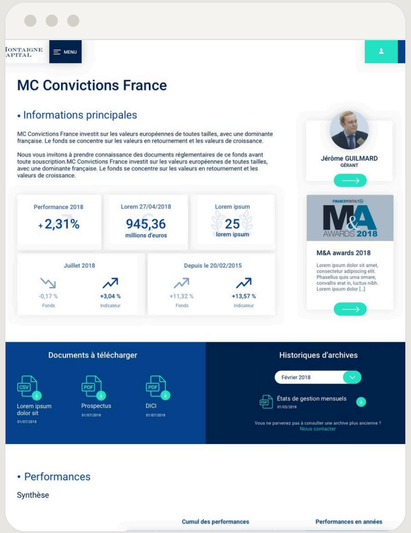
1 Internal project-tracking tool



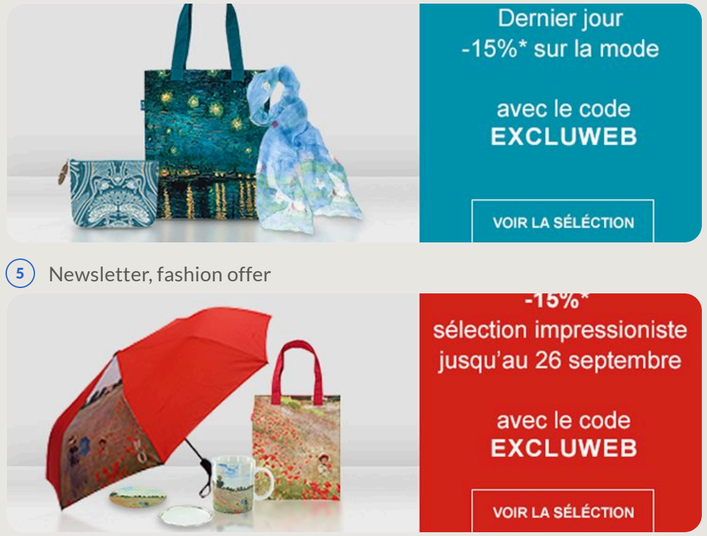
2 Weekly view and activity tracking



3 Montaigne Capital, home page



4 Fund page



5 Newsletter, fashion offer

6 Newsletter, Impressionist selection

INTERNAL TOOL

Project tracking: tickets by client and by team member, time spent, weekly and monthly views.

MONTAIGNE CAPITAL

An asset manager's website: home page, fund pages, regulatory documents.

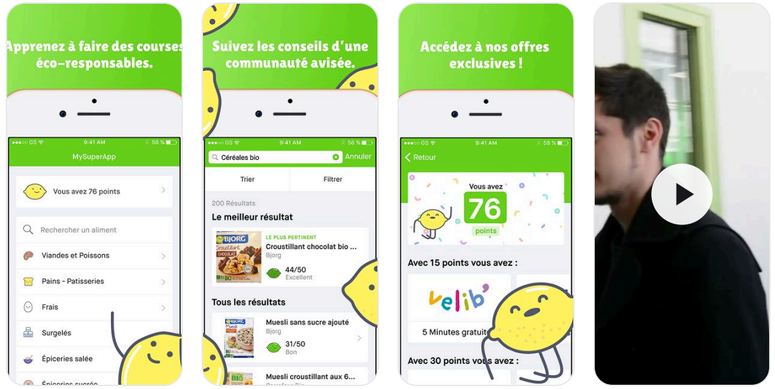
NEWSLETTERS

Banners for a museum shop, around works by Van Gogh and Monet.

BAIO · MOBILE APP CONCEPT

A gamified app that encourages healthier shopping

A complete mobile journey: onboarding, search, shopping lists, receipt scanning, points and partner offers, plus its animated presentation video.



LE GRAND MÉNAGE · SHORT FILM

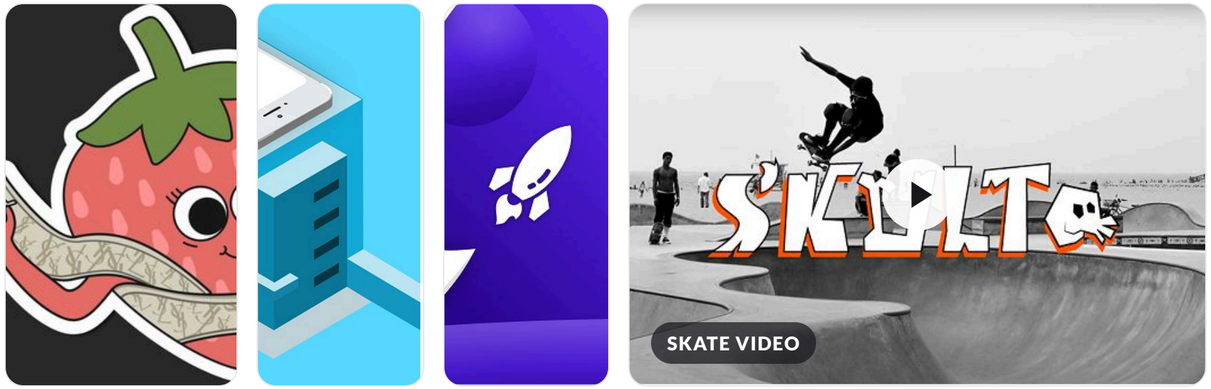
A film in two weeks, from writing to editing

Made with a multidisciplinary team: dividing roles, sticking to a tight shooting schedule and converging on a coherent film, delivered on time.



ARCHIVE · PERSONAL WORK

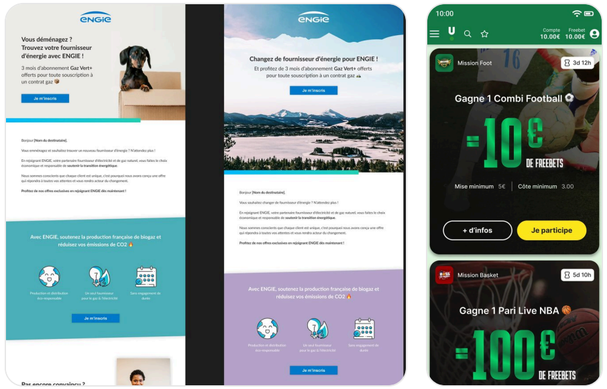
Illustration, graphic research and video



DESIGN EXERCISES

Engie, finalist, and Unibet

Two exercises taken during recruitment processes: marketing emails for Engie, and for Unibet a mobile prototype of missions that earn free bets.



Thank you!

A product to grow? Let's talk about your team, your users and what you want to ship.

contact@paulhoudebine.com

+33 6 45 77 95 83

linkedin.com/in/paul-houdebine

paulhoudebine.com



SCAN TO SEE THE PORTFOLIO

Projects, case studies and method